

- HFS+
- ReiserFS (does not work very well with this file system)

Getting PhotoRec

While most distributions include TestDisk (which, in turn, has PhotoRec) in their repositories, you can download the source file or the RPM for your distro from www.cgsecurity.org/wiki/TestDisk_Download. Alternatively, you can go for PartedMagic (~90 MB in size), which contains TestDisk and a host of other utilities. This is available at downloads.sourceforge.net/partedmagic/pmagic-3.7.iso.zip.

The road to recovery

You can use PhotoRec to recover data or pictures that have been deleted from a pen drive. You can also recover data from a partition of a hard disk and save it to another partition on the same disk. The only condition is the partition to which data will be saved should be equal to or larger than the partition from which data will be recovered.

You will require a card reader for digital camera flash drives. Hard disks require a suitable USB enclosure. Alternatively, you can connect hard disks to an internal slot.

Step 1: Create a directory called *photorec_dir* where PhotoRec will save files. Connect the flash/hard disk drive to your USB port/internal port (or just select your internal drive if you want to recover data from a partition) and fire up PhotoRec from the terminal as the superuser:

```
[root@localhost ~]# photorec
```

PhotoRec will display all your hard disks and USB drives. Choose the drive from which data needs to be recovered (Figure 1).

Step 2: Up next is to choose the partition table type (Figure 2). PhotoRec supports a number of partition table types—Intel/PC, Apple, Sun Solaris, XBox, EFI GPT partition and 'None' partition types. Choose the Intel/PC type, which most of us use anyway. Even if you have a single partition, do not choose the 'None' option.

Step 3: The next screen offers the option to recover data from the whole disk or the choice of selecting a partition. Choose your option using the up/down arrow keys. In case of a disk with multiple partitions, PhotoRec will display all the partitions, similar to what *fdisk -l* option does. Select the partition that contains the deleted data using up/down arrow keys (Figure 3).

Step 4: We now come to the most important step of the recovery process. Select the 'File Opt' option using the left/right arrow keys and press *Enter*. PhotoRec puts forth a huge list of about 140 different



Figure 1: Choose the drive from which data has to be recovered

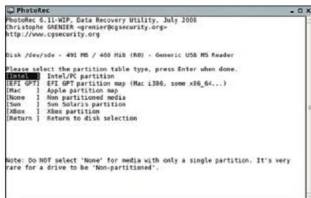


Figure 2: Choose the partition type

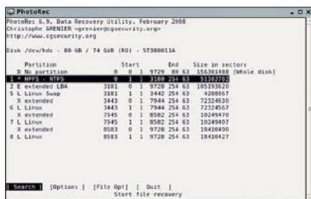


Figure 3: Choose the partition of a drive



Figure 4: Choose the file types to recover